

Environmental
E-03 Bites / Stings / Envenomation BLS

SNAKE BITES ➤ If snake is dead, transport to Emergency Department in appropriate container. ➤ Assess the site of the wound for swelling or redness from bite. Circle the affected area of the skin, noting the time. ➤ Avoid excessive movement of the affected extremity, immobilize at or slightly below the level of the heart. ➤ Keep the patient at rest. ➤ Do NOT incise the skin; do NOT apply ice, tourniquet or any other constricting device; ➤ Monitor distal pulses.	BEES / WASPS ➤ Remove stinger by scraping it off the skin. Do not squeeze. ➤ Apply cold packs.
SPIDER BITES / SCORPION STINGS ➤ If possible transport spider to Emergency Department in sealed container. ➤ Apply cold pack to affected area; ➤ Avoid excessive movement, keeping the affected extremity dependent.	JELLY FISH ➤ Rinse site of sting with alcohol or salt water without rubbing or applying pressure.
STING RAY ➤ Soak in warm water. ➤ Do not remove barb.	

DISRUPTED COMMUNICATIONS

In the event that a Solano County EMT-P is UNABLE to make physician contact for orders, the paramedic MAY NOT utilize those areas of the protocol needing physician direction and MUST TRANSPORT IMMEDIATELY TO THE CLOSEST FACILITY.

Environmental
E-03 Bites / Stings / Envenomation BLS

Revised 3/1/2000

PRIORITIES:

- ABCs
- Keep patient calm; determine degree of physiologic distress;
- Do not apply ice
- Accurate description of snake, spider, insect, etc.
- Assure an advanced life support response
- Attempt to initiate prompt transport when available

Poisonous Bites and Stings (Basic Therapy)

1. Ensure a patent airway (suction as necessary);
2. Be prepared to support ventilation with appropriate airway adjuncts;
3. OXYGEN THERAPY – Begin oxygen at 6 liters/minute by nasal cannula or 10 liters/minute by mask.
4. Identify causative agent. If it can be safely handled, consider bringing to hospital, request assistance of animal control;
5. Monitor vital signs frequently;
6. Remove rings, bracelets, or other constricting items on the bitten extremity;
7. Assist advanced life support personnel with patient packaging and movement to ambulance;
8. If exhibiting signs of allergic reaction or shock, treat per PROTOCOL m-5, ANAPHYLAXIS.

Jelly Fish

1. Rinse site of sting with alcohol or salt water without rubbing or applying pressure.

Sting Ray

1. Rinse site of sting with alcohol or salt water without rubbing or applying pressure.

Bees/Wasps

1. Remove stinger by scraping it off skin. Do NOT squeeze stinger;
2. Apply cold packs;
3. See Protocol m-5, ANAPHYLAXIS

Snake Bites

1. Avoid excessive movement of the affected extremity; keeping it in neutral position relative to the heart;
2. Circle the affected area of the skin, noting the time on the skin as well;
3. Do NOT incise skin, apply tourniquets or apply ice;
4. Monitor distal pulses.

Spider Bites/Scorpion Stings

1. Apply cold pack to affected area;
2. Avoid excessive movement, keeping the affected extremity dependent.

Environmental
E-03 Bites / Stings / Envenomation

PRIORITIES ➤ ABCs ➤ Keep patient calm, determine degree of physiologic distress ➤ EARLY TRANSPORT/BASE NOTIFICATION (after initiating therapy, if appropriate). ➤ Accurate description of snake, spider, insect, etc. ➤ EARLY CONTACT OF RECEIVING HOSPITAL.	Reviewed & Changed July 2006
--	---

PATIENT TREATMENT GUIDELINES

- Stabilize airway.
- **OXYGEN** therapy – as needed;
- **CARDIAC MONITOR**
- **IV** Access **TKO**; use unaffected extremity
- **CONSIDER SPECIFIC TREATMENTS:**
- See next page for specific treatments;

DISRUPTED COMMUNICATIONS

In the event that a Solano County EMT-P is UNABLE to make physician contact for orders, the paramedic MAY NOT utilize those areas of the protocol needing physician direction and MUST TRANSPORT IMMEDIATELY TO THE CLOSEST FACILITY.